

Prior to 2023 you had a terrible record against some pairs. It was 0-8 against Aaron Chia and Soh Wooi Yik. You have two wins now — including one at the Asian Games. What clicked?

Chirag: I think we got our first win in the Indonesia Open final. What changed was that we didn't really hold ourselves back. Earlier, when we used to play them, we were like — "Oh my God! If we don't play perfectly, they'll just come and tap it." Aaron has a really good spin serve. We used to be extra cautious when we were receiving it.

In that final, we were like — "Even if we make a mistake, it does not matter but we need to be the ones taking charge." We actually started 5-2 down, because we hit the first few service returns pretty much out of the court.

But we said it was okay. We need to take the shuttle high when he is doing that spin serve because then eventually, they'll have to lift it. The attitude changed completely from there on. Even in the Asian Games final, we did the same thing. We were the ones dictating the terms.

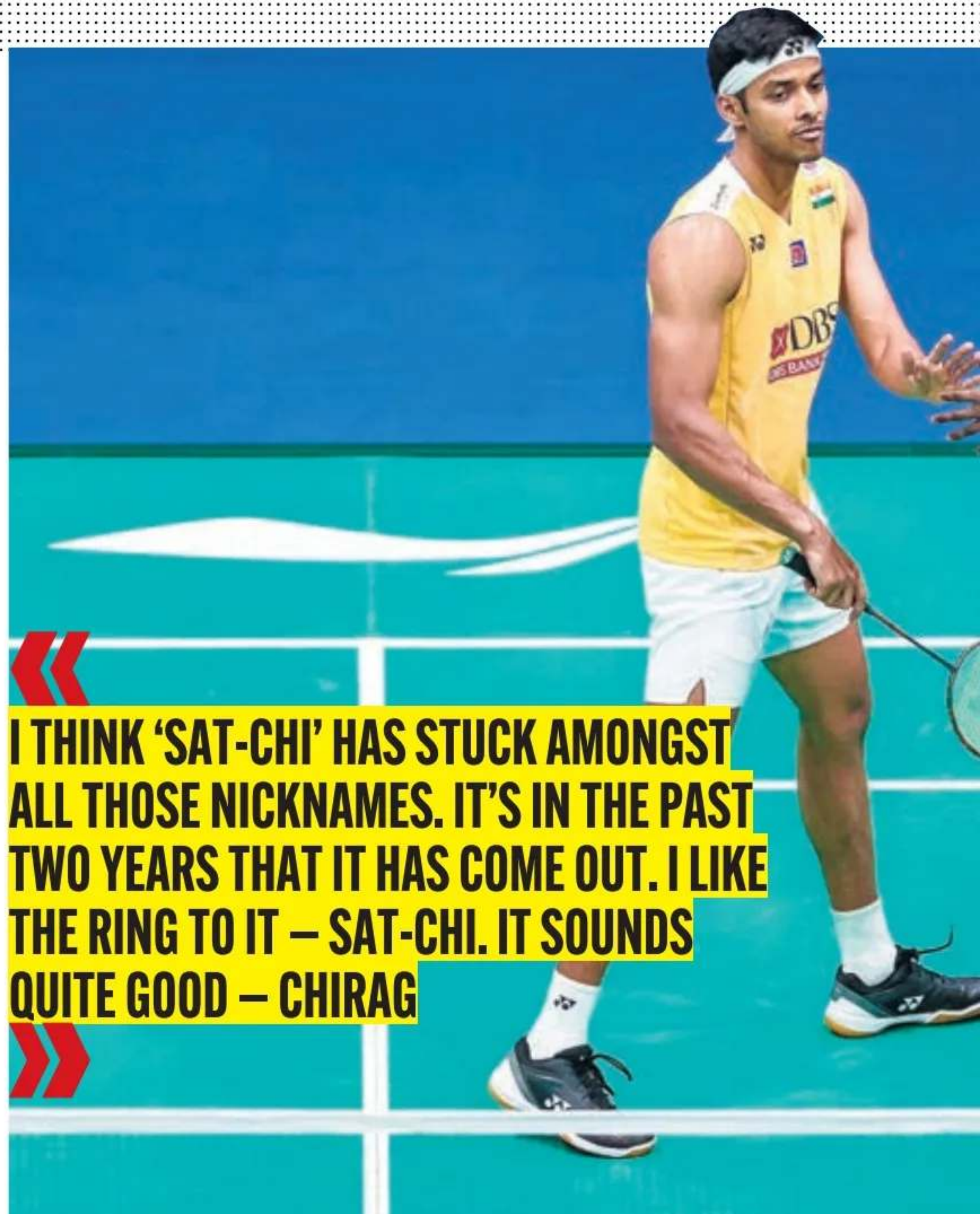
You guys have multiple nicknames — Twin Towers, Brothers of Destruction, Sat-Chi. Which ones do you prefer? Do you have any nicknames for each other?

Chirag: I think 'Sat-Chi' has stuck amongst all those nicknames. It's in the past two years that it has come out. I like the ring to it — Sat-Chi. It sounds quite good. Between each other, Satwik calls me 'Shetty bhai' and I call him 'Satwik'. I don't call a lot of people by their nicknames.

Chirag, you have become a bit of an icon with your choice of headbands. Why did you choose those colours?

Chirag: I have headbands in four or five colours. I don't choose them according to the match I'm playing. It can be any random colour but, in the quarterfinals, semifinals and final, I pretty much keep it the same — white, yellow or orange.

The orange one is what I mostly



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use in the final.

What about you Satwik?

Satwik: I just cut my hair before tournaments. Otherwise, it comes over my eyes when I play. The length to which I keep my hair depends on how many tournaments I'm going to be away from home. I've tried wearing headbands before, but I didn't like it. It's not my style. There needs to be one stylish player on the court and that's Shetty *bhai*. I don't want to take his place. We have a few girl fans when we are playing, and they will call Shetty *bhai* — Chirag Chirag! Throw your T-shirt! And that is enough for me!

You guys also have very iconic celebrations after your wins. How

did that start?

Chirag: It probably started after the Thomas Cup, where I removed my T-shirt and Satwik did his first dance. Neither of us planned it but it came about because of the environment and because of our teammates and stuff. After that it became something of a ritual. At the Korean Open we did the Gangnam Style celebration because we felt it would be quite good to do it in Korea.

What's the best reaction you got to these celebrations?

Chirag: I had the grandmother of one of my friends commenting under one of these posts saying you shouldn't remove your T-shirts. You win the match and it's OK that you are happy, but you don't remove your